TRIBUTE EDITION · UNOFFICIAL

COLD EMAIL

The Cold Email Pre-Send Check

A 14-point scorecard to run before any cold email goes out: short, one ask, proof in the buyer's own metric, a first email worth reading and follow-ups that add something.



Based on a post on X by

Atishay · @atishayhyperke

https://x.com/atishayhyperke/status/2112906923058012235

6 principles | 14-point scorecard | Proof-matching worksheet | AI reviewer prompt

Free kit · Gifted · Not for sale · Original synthesis by Gilbert Cruz · October 2026

THE METHOD

Six principles behind the checklist

Atishay shared on X a 14-item checklist for cold email copy, drawn from his team's large-scale outbound work. Its spine is simple: keep it short, ask for one thing, prove relevance with the number your buyer actually tracks, make the first email worth the reader's time, and never follow up with an empty bump. This kit turns it into a scorecard you can run in five minutes.

Two key terms

CTA: the single action you ask the reader to take.

Buyer metric: the number your prospect already counts: booked appointments, jobs, service calls, demos.

STEP 1	**Short by default** Aim for roughly 70 words; go close to 30 when the offer is simple and the next step is easy. Short forces clarity.
STEP 2	**One ask** One call to action, phrased as a specific question that's easy to answer. Two asks invite "later", and later becomes no reply.
STEP 3	**Relevant proof** A small case from the prospect's own industry beats a big one from another. Speak in their metric. Keep it to one line or a PS.
STEP 4	**Email 1 earns attention** Offer a partial deliverable, a small diagnostic or a useful resource, or simply state a clearly good offer. If you offer a free audit, sell what the audit produces.
STEP 5	**Follow-ups add something** New proof, more context, a clearer next step or a routing question ("who handles this?"). Never a bump-only email.
STEP 6	**Rotate structure, keep proof** When you test new scripts, keep the proof constant and change the structure around it, so you know what made the difference.

> An idea from the original post worth taping to your screen: **"free" still costs your prospect time and attention**, so the email has to justify it.

SCORECARD

The 14-point pre-send check

Tick each point before sending. Anything below 12 goes back for a rewrite.

Area	Check	✓
Length	Around 70 words or fewer	
Length	Close to 30 words if the offer is simple	
Ask	Exactly one call to action	
Ask	Ends on a specific, easy-to-answer question	
Proof	Proof comes from the prospect's industry	
Proof	Proof uses the metric the buyer counts	
Proof	Proof fits in one line or a PS	
Proof	Same proof kept while testing a new structure	
Email 1	Gives value: partial deliverable, diagnostic or resource	
Email 1	Or states a clearly good offer plainly	
Email 1	If it offers an audit, it says what the audit produces	
Email 1	Justifies the time "free" still costs	
Follow-up	Adds proof, context or a clearer next step	
Follow-up	Wrong person? Asks who the right one is	

Score: 14 = send · 12–13 = quick fix · below 12 = rewrite.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Before and after: a web studio writing to clinics

FICTIONAL EXAMPLE · INVENTED PEOPLE AND DATA

A small web studio emails physiotherapy clinics. The first version fails most of the scorecard; the rewrite passes.

BEFORE · ~75 WORDS · 2 ASKS

Hi Dr. Patel, I hope this email finds you well! I run a digital agency that has worked with over 200 businesses in retail, SaaS and hospitality. We offer web design, SEO, paid ads and social media. I'd love to set up a 30-minute call to walk you through our services, and also send you our full brochure. Would you be free this week or next? Let me know what works and I'll send an invite.

AFTER · ~55 WORDS · 1 ASK

Hi Dr. Patel, I tried booking on your site and found two steps where patients are likely to drop off before picking a time. We fixed the same thing for a two-room physio clinic: 14 more booked appointments a month. Want me to send a 3-minute video showing both fixes on your site?

Buyer	What they count	My proof in their metric
Physio clinic	Booked appointments	+14 booked appointments/month for a 2-room clinic
Plumbing firm	Jobs and call-outs	
Your buyer:		

Fictional example: clinic, studio and numbers are invented to illustrate the method. No results are promised.

PROMPT, CREDIT AND NOTICE

AI prompt (short version)

```
Act as a strict cold email reviewer. Score my email against
these 14 checks (pass/fail + one-line reason): ~70 words or
fewer; ~30 if the offer is simple; one CTA; ends on an easy
question; proof from the prospect's industry; proof in the
buyer's metric; proof in one line/PS; value or a clearly good
offer in email 1; audit offers say what they produce; justifies
the time "free" costs; follow-ups add something; asks for the
right person if needed. Then rewrite it to pass. Don't invent
proof: if I haven't given you a real case, ask me for one.
```

Full step-by-step version in prompt.md.

Use it in 30 minutes

1. Pick the next cold email you're about to send.
2. Score it with the 14 checks (page 3), or paste it into the AI with the prompt above.
3. Fill in the proof-matching worksheet (page 4) with one real case before you rewrite.

Credit and notice

> **Atishay · @atishayhyperke**
> https://x.com/atishayhyperke/status/2112906923058012235
>
> The original checklist, on length, one ask, relevant proof in the buyer's metric, a valuable first email and follow-ups that add something, is by **Atishay (@atishayhyperke)**, posted on X on 21 October 2026.
>
> This kit is an original synthesis and a free, unofficial expansion.

- **Free and gifted**: not for sale or resale.
- **Unofficial** tribute: Atishay has not reviewed or endorsed it.
- Original synthesis: no text, images or branding reproduced from the author.
- Examples are fictional and no results are promised.
- If the author wants changes or removal, it happens, no questions asked.

Prepared by **Gilbert Cruz**: Venezuelan-Spaniard living nomadically in Asia; years in private security and close protection, a juvenile justice centre and working in luxury concierge in Ibiza.